

Ayman Zahran — LinkedIn Profile

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Headline

AWS/Azure/GCP/VMware/Kubernetes Cloud/DevOps/Platform/SRE/AI Freelancer |
AWS Community Builder | AWS Certification SME | Kubestronaut | 11x AWS | 5x Azure
| 2x GCP | 4x VMware | 5x Kubernetes | 3x Hashicorp | MBA | DBA

About (Summary)

Cloud / DevOps / Platform / SRE / AI Freelancer with comprehensive expertise in cloud computing, containerization, and Infrastructure as Code across AWS, Azure, GCP, VMware, and Kubernetes environments. Proven track record leading cloud migration initiatives and infrastructure transformations with uptime SLAs of 99.9%+. Skilled in Kubernetes orchestration, CI/CD automation, configuration management, and complex multi-cloud environments. Active AI / LLM practitioner: production multi-provider LLM integrations (Anthropic Claude · OpenAI · Google Gemini), MCP (Model Context Protocol) tool servers, agentic workflows, retrieval-augmented generation, prompt engineering for Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Pulumi), AI-augmented CI/CD pipelines, and AI-assisted code review. Shipped production AI SaaS apps: merge.news (AI-curated daily cloud / DevOps / AI brief — Cloud Functions + Gemini + Google Search grounding; multi-provider LLM router; web + iOS + Android clients) and outbox (AI-assisted social-media scheduler for X and LinkedIn with multi-provider AI drafting). Passionate about harnessing automation to improve processes, reduce manual efforts, cut costs, and accelerate time to market. Proficient developer across multiple languages including PowerShell, Bash, C, C++, C#, VB.NET, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, and more. Adept in networking, Linux/Windows administration, VMware technologies, Dell and Cisco systems, and telecom mediation platforms. Strong advocate of “Everything as Code” — and increasingly “Everything as AI-Assisted Code” — leveraging AI to augment human capabilities in business innovation and performance.

Experience

Tech Lead

Virtasant — Austin, Texas, United States

October 2023 - Present

- Led migration strategy from cloud provider infrastructure to private cloud platform, redesigning multi-account infrastructure for better resource allocation and increased IP

space.

- Directed a team of 4-5 SREs managing critical CI/CD infrastructure supporting 1000+ daily pipeline executions. Established IaC standards that reduced deployment times by 75% across 20+ Kubernetes clusters.
- Designed disaster recovery and high availability strategies across 2 regions achieving 99.95% uptime SLAs. Coordinated all production deployments during bi-weekly maintenance windows.
- Implemented automated compliance checking and vulnerability remediation reducing security findings by 90%. Standardized deployment processes across 25+ microservices, cutting failure rates by 60%.
- Created 30+ runbooks and 20+ operational procedures, reducing MTTR by 40%. Managed incident response for 15+ priority one incidents with zero SLA breaches.

DevOps Engineer

Virtasant — Austin, Texas, United States

October 2022 - October 2023

- Managed and optimized 30+ Kubernetes clusters supporting CI/CD infrastructure; performed quarterly upgrades across 11 Kubernetes versions (1.21 to 1.32) with automated update processes for 100+ components reducing manual effort by 80%.
- Migrated container networking solutions on 10+ EKS clusters, improving network performance by 30%. Upgraded CI/CD pipelines across 10 environments handling 500+ daily builds.
- Configured and maintained Prometheus, AlertManager, and Grafana monitoring stack tracking 200+ custom metrics. Implemented security compliance migrations achieving 100% PSA compliance.
- Managed bi-monthly secret rotation and credential management for 50+ service accounts using secure vault solutions. Automated infrastructure deployments with Terraform and Pulumi.
- Configured GitOps workflows for continuous deployment on 12 clusters, enabling 20+ daily code deployments. Applied cost optimization strategies reducing storage and autoscaling expenses by 35%.

DevOps Lead

Netways — Dubai, UAE

February 2023 - June 2023

- Led Azure Cloud DevOps transformation delivering 5+ projects that cut operational costs by 40% and increased deployment frequency by 5x.
- Built and optimized 50+ Azure DevOps pipelines and managed 20+ repositories automating end-to-end CI/CD workflows, decreasing release cycles from weekly to daily.
- Implemented Terraform IaC with reusable modules across 5+ Azure environments reducing provisioning times by 70%. Standardized Kubernetes deployments with 25+ Helm charts achieving 99.9% deployment success.
- Mentored 5+ team members on Azure DevOps practices through bi-weekly workshops, boosting team productivity by 35%. Gathered requirements and achieved 95% customer satisfaction across 10+ stakeholders.
- Established integration strategies connecting 8+ cross-functional teams, reducing inter-team dependencies by 30%. Managed Azure infrastructure supporting 30+ microservices with cost-optimization practices.

DevOps Consultant

Syntheia — Sydney, Australia

October 2022 - February 2023

- Developed and executed DevOps strategies for 3+ enterprise clients, cutting deployment cycles by 60% and raising system reliability to 99.95% uptime.

- Deployed 5+ production EKS and AKS clusters on AWS and Azure supporting 10+ microservices. Implemented GitOps deployments with Flux reducing manual steps by 80%.
- Standardized deployment processes by creating 15+ Helm charts based on best practices, lowering configuration errors by 75%. Authored 30+ technical documentation guides and delivered team handovers.
- Automated multi-cloud Kubernetes cluster provisioning with Terraform, deploying 12+ clusters in under 30 minutes with reusable modules serving 3+ clients.
- Established CI/CD pipelines with integrated security scanning and compliance checks yielding 100% automated, vulnerability-free deployments.

L3 DevOps Engineer

Rackspace Technology — Cairo, Egypt

April 2022 - October 2022

- Designed cloud architecture for 10+ microservice applications on AWS, reducing infrastructure costs by 45% through optimized resource use.
- Automated deployment pipelines via Jenkins, GitHub Enterprise, and Ansible, cutting release times from 4 hours to 30 minutes supporting 50+ weekly deployments.
- Managed Kubernetes and EKS workloads with 100+ pods at 99.9% uptime. Built monitoring dashboards using CloudWatch, Prometheus, and Grafana reducing MTTR by 65%.
- Resolved 30+ complex monthly issues for development and data engineering teams. Implemented security best practices across 15+ AWS accounts to achieve SOC2 compliance.
- Led migration of 12 monolithic apps to microservices on EKS improving scalability by 70%. Mentored 10+ developers via weekly knowledge sharing improving team self-sufficiency by 50%.

L2 Professional Services Delivery Engineer

Rackspace Technology — Alexandria, Egypt

December 2021 - April 2022

- Delivered 25+ AWS cloud solutions for enterprises, reducing infrastructure deployment time from weeks to hours through automation.
- Applied Terraform, CloudFormation, Runway, and Serverless Framework reducing manual configuration errors by 90%. Architected solutions across 20+ AWS services optimizing costs by 35%.
- Implemented security frameworks using AWS IAM, Security Groups, and KMS achieving full compliance for 3+ clients.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with CodePipeline and CodeBuild, accelerating release cycles from monthly to weekly while automating monitoring with CloudWatch reducing incident response by 60%.
- Migrated 4 on-premises workloads to AWS reducing operational costs by 40%. Conducted knowledge transfers for 10+ client engineers ensuring solution sustainability.

Technical Support Engineer

Dell Technologies — Cairo, Egypt

February 2021 - November 2021

- Handled 200+ monthly tickets for VBlock/VxBlock infrastructure achieving 95% first-call resolution exceeding SLAs by 20%.
- Supported VMware (vSphere, NSX, VRealize Suite), EMC storage (VMAX, VNX, Isilon), Cisco networking (MDS, N3K/N5K/N9K), and compute (Cisco UCS, Dell PowerEdge).
- Managed VPLEX and RecoverPoint for 100+ TB data ensuring 99.9% availability

across 30+ deployments.

- Created 50+ knowledge base articles contributing to a 25% reduction in team resolution times while maintaining 98% customer satisfaction.

Technical Support Engineer

Vodafone — Cairo, Egypt

August 2020 - February 2021

- Provided 24/7 support for Telecom IN/Mediation infrastructure with 99.9% uptime across 50+ production nodes.
- Administered Ericsson IN ecosystem handling CCN, OCC, SDP, AIR, VS, and EMM hardware/software components.
- Commissioned 15+ new IN nodes reducing deployment times by 30%; resolved 50+ issues monthly with 85% first-call resolution.
- Executed 20+ quarterly upgrades supporting 40% traffic growth; integrated SPLUNK monitoring on 12 nodes reducing detection time by 60%.

Full Stack Developer

Echo Egypt — Cairo, Egypt

May 2018 - July 2020

- Developed and deployed 5+ desktop and web applications end-to-end managing infrastructure and application layers achieving 99% customer satisfaction and reducing delivery time by 35%.
- Built enterprise solutions using C#, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Microsoft AD, IIS, SSMS, and .NET improving operational efficiency by 40%, processing 100K+ daily transactions.
- Engineered and integrated scalable APIs and backend services enhancing cross-platform interoperability supporting mission-critical workflows.

Education

Swiss School of Business and Management Geneva (SSBM Geneva)

Doctor of Business Administration (DBA)

June 2025 - May 2027 (in progress)

Dissertation: From Human Freelancers to Autonomous AI Agents: A Framework for Assessing Efficiency, ROI, and Business Transformation in Freelance Platforms. Framework for evaluating how freelance platforms adopt AI — efficiency, ROI, and business-model transformation. Hybrid platforms (Upwork, Fiverr, Toptal, 99designs).

Zigurat Innovation & Technology Business School / Universitat de Barcelona

Master of Business Administration (MBA), Digital Transformation

October 2023 - December 2024

Thesis: Revolutionizing IT Infrastructure: Innovating Cloud and DevOps Solutions Through Polyglot Programming Paradigms.

FMT / capstone: EchoOps — a designed Cloud / DevOps startup (not an employer) around Everything as Code and polyglot programming.

Cairo University

Bachelor's degree, Communication and Computer

2012 - 2018

Ministry of Communications and Information Technology (MCIT)

AWS Practical Data Scientist Academy

October 2021 - March 2022

National Telecommunication Institute (NTI)
Datacenter Infrastructure Virtualization
February 2020 - April 2020

Sakkara Language School
IGCSE
2009 - 2011

Sakkara Language School
Primary and Preparatory Education
1999 - 2008

Licenses & Certifications

Amazon Web Services (AWS)

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (Jan 2022)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (Apr 2022)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (Jan 2021)
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate (Jan 2022)
- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional (Jan 2022)
- AWS Certified Security – Specialty (May 2022)
- AWS Certified Machine Learning – Specialty (Jun 2022)
- AWS Certified Data Analytics – Specialty (Mar 2022)
- AWS Certified Database – Specialty (May 2022)
- AWS Partner: SAP on AWS (Business and Technical) (Aug-Sep 2022)
- AWS Partner: Sales and Cloud Economics Accreditation (Aug 2022)
- Migration Ambassador Foundations (Business) (Jul 2022)
- AWS Learning: Object Storage (Jul 2022)

Microsoft

- Microsoft Certified Azure Fundamentals (Jun 2020)
- Microsoft Certified Azure Administrator Associate (Apr 2021)
- Microsoft Certified Azure AI Fundamentals (Jul 2022)
- Microsoft Certified Azure Data Fundamentals (Jul 2022)
- Microsoft Certified Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (Oct 2022)

VMware

- VMware Certified Professional - Data Center Virtualization (2020, 2021)
- VMware Certified Professional - Network Virtualization (2020, 2021)
- VMware Certified Associate - Digital Business Transformation (2020)
- VMware vSphere 6.7 Foundations (May 2020)

Linux Foundation

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (Sep 2022)
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) (Sep 2022)
- Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS) (Sep 2022)
- Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (KCNA) (Sep 2022)

Cisco

- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) (Jun 2020)

Dell Technologies

- Associate - Information Storage and Management Version 4.0 (Jun 2020)

IBM

- Deep Learning, Deep Learning using TensorFlow, Accelerated Deep Learning with GPU (2022)
- Multiple Data Science Foundations and Applied Data Science with Python Levels 1 & 2 (2022)
- Containers & Kubernetes Essentials (Jul 2021)
- Docker Essentials: A Developer Introduction (Jul 2021)
- IBM Cloud Essentials (Jul 2021)

Kaggle

- Computer Vision, Data Cleaning, Data Visualization, Feature Engineering, Intermediate Machine Learning, Intro to Deep Learning, Intro to Machine Learning, Intro to SQL, Pandas, Python, Time Series (certifications achieved)

Triplebyte

- Triplebyte Certified (Aug 2022)

Rackspace Technology

- Rackspace MultiCloud Practitioner (Aug 2022)
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Skills

Cloud Platforms

- Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

DevOps & Automation Tools

- Terraform, Ansible, Pulumi, Terragrunt, env0, Packer, Vagrant, Serverless Framework, AWS CloudFormation, Cloud Development Kit (CDK, CDKTF, CDK8s), Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, BitBucket Pipelines, Azure Pipelines, Azure Boards, Azure Repos, Tekton, Spinnaker, Flux, ArgoCD, Runway, JFrog

Containerization & Orchestration

- Docker, Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, Azure AKS, Helm, ECS, ECSCLI, EKSCTL

Programming & Scripting

- PowerShell, Bash, PowerCLI, C, C++, C#, VB.NET, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, PHP, HTML, CSS, YAML, JSON, HCL, Groovy

Monitoring & Logging

- Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, AlertManager, SPLUNK, OpenTelemetry

Databases

- MSSQL, MySQL, AWS RDS

Networking & Infrastructure

- VMware vSphere/vCenter, NSX-V/T, vSAN, Cisco UCS, Nexus/MDS Switches, Dell PowerEdge Servers, VMAX, VNX, Isilon, XIO

Telecommunications

- Ericsson IN (MSCs, GGSNs, CCNs, OCCs, SDPs, AIRs, VSs, EMM)

Data Science & AI

- Data Ingestion, Streaming, Predictive Analytics, Visualization, AI fundamentals, Deep Learning, TensorFlow
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Projects / Accomplishments / Volunteer Experience / Publications / Interests

Volunteer Experience

- AWS Community Builder (Mar 2022 - Present): Active member contributing to technical knowledge sharing and community engagement.
- AWS Certification Subject Matter Expert (SME) (May 2022 - Present): Participates in AWS certification exam development, creating and reviewing exam content remotely and in-person.

Accomplishments

- Led multiple cloud migration and infrastructure transformation projects achieving uptime SLAs of 99.9%+ and cost reductions up to 45%.
- Successfully automated CI/CD pipelines supporting thousands of daily deployments reducing release times by up to 90%.
- Standardized and scaled Kubernetes deployments across multi-cloud environments supporting dozens of microservices.
- Authored comprehensive documentation and runbooks reducing MTTR by 40%.
- Mentored teams and improved customer satisfaction ratings consistently above 95%.

Publications / Blogs

- “Building CDK Construct Library, CDK App and CDK Pipelines using Projen”
- “Build Your Kubernetes Playground in Less Than 5 Minutes for FREE!!”

Interests

- Virtualization, Containerization, Cloud Computing, SDLC, Infrastructure as Code, Configuration Management, GitOps, Automation, Data Science, AI, Data Analytics, Digital Transformation

Languages

- Arabic: Native or Bilingual
- English: Professional Working Proficiency
- French: Elementary Proficiency